

Adam Bawatneh

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Dear Amazon Research Science Hiring Committee,

I am a Computer Science Ph.D. student at the University of Central Florida applying for a research science internship. My research focuses on social reasoning and Theory of Mind in large language models. I am interested in research roles where I can develop a clear question, implement an evaluation, and use experimental results to understand model behavior.

I am the first author of OmniToM, accepted to the NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations and Datasets Track. OmniToM evaluates whether language models can recover the beliefs held by different people in a story. I helped build its human-labeled benchmark, coordinated annotation quality checks, and evaluated API and open-weight models across Azure OpenAI, Anthropic, Vertex AI, and university and NSF ACCESS high-performance computing resources. This work has taught me to connect dataset construction, implementation, and analysis while checking where model performance breaks down.

I also mentored an REU student on a project for detecting specialized language. We combined translation instability, masked-language-model likelihood, surface features, and model agreement, then tested how well the approach transferred across domains and languages. As a Graduate Research Assistant, I contribute to research proposal development, including IARPA-focused proposals. I have also reviewed papers for NeurIPS, AAAI, and ACL. These experiences have strengthened my ability to evaluate research carefully and communicate its limits.

I would be glad to bring my experience in language-model evaluation, benchmark development, and research implementation to an Amazon research team. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Adam Bawatneh